

MICROSOFT EXCEL 2025

A Step-by-step Practical Guide for
Beginners and Advanced Users



EVELYN NEUMANN

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A STEP-BY-STEP PRACTICAL GUIDE
FOR BEGINNERS AND ADVANCED
USERS

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INTRODUCTION

Imagine holding in your hands a book that doesn't just inform but transforms. A book that takes you on an intellectual adventure, where each page unfolds a deeper understanding, unraveling mysteries you never knew existed. This is not just another book—it's a journey. A carefully crafted experience designed to challenge your thoughts, sharpen your perspective, and leave you with an undeniable sense of enlightenment.

Have you ever read something so compelling that you lost track of time? A book that made your heart race with anticipation, urging you to turn the next page, not out of obligation, but out of sheer curiosity? That's exactly what you're about to experience.

Within these pages, you'll find more than just words. You'll discover clarity where there was once confusion, solutions where there were obstacles, and a fresh perspective that might just change the way you see everything. Each chapter has been meticulously structured for your maximum engagement—crafted not just to inform, but to immerse, provoke thought, and ignite action.

What makes this book different? It's not just a collection of facts and theories; it's a carefully designed roadmap to understanding. A step-by-step unraveling of concepts, broken down into digestible insights, ensuring that you not only read but truly grasp and apply the knowledge.

So, I invite you—no, I challenge you—to dive in. Read with curiosity. Question with boldness. Absorb with an open mind. Because what lies ahead is more than just a book. It's an experience. And once you turn this page, there's no turning back.

Welcome to a world of discovery.

CHAPTER 1

Up and Running with Excel

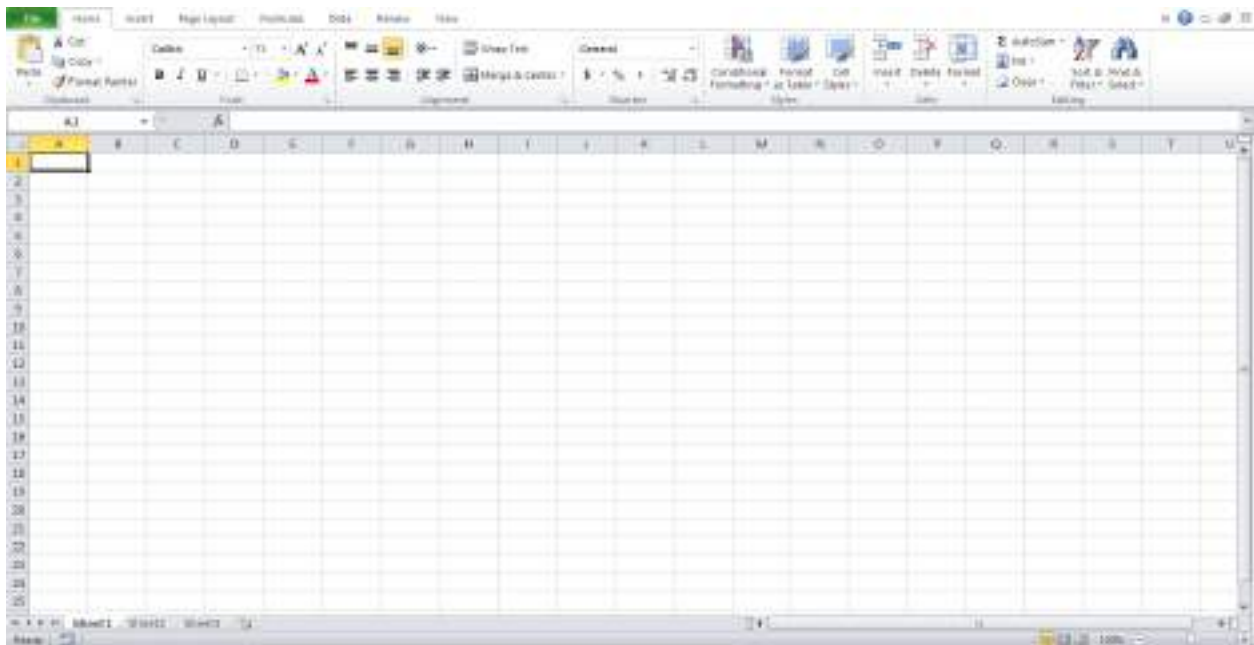
In this chapter, we will introduce you to Microsoft Excel and guide you through the essential first steps, from creating a new workbook to mastering basic data entry and formatting techniques. Whether you are a beginner or an experienced user, this chapter will ensure you're comfortable with Excel's environment and understand how to efficiently use the essential tools.

Creating a New Excel Workbook

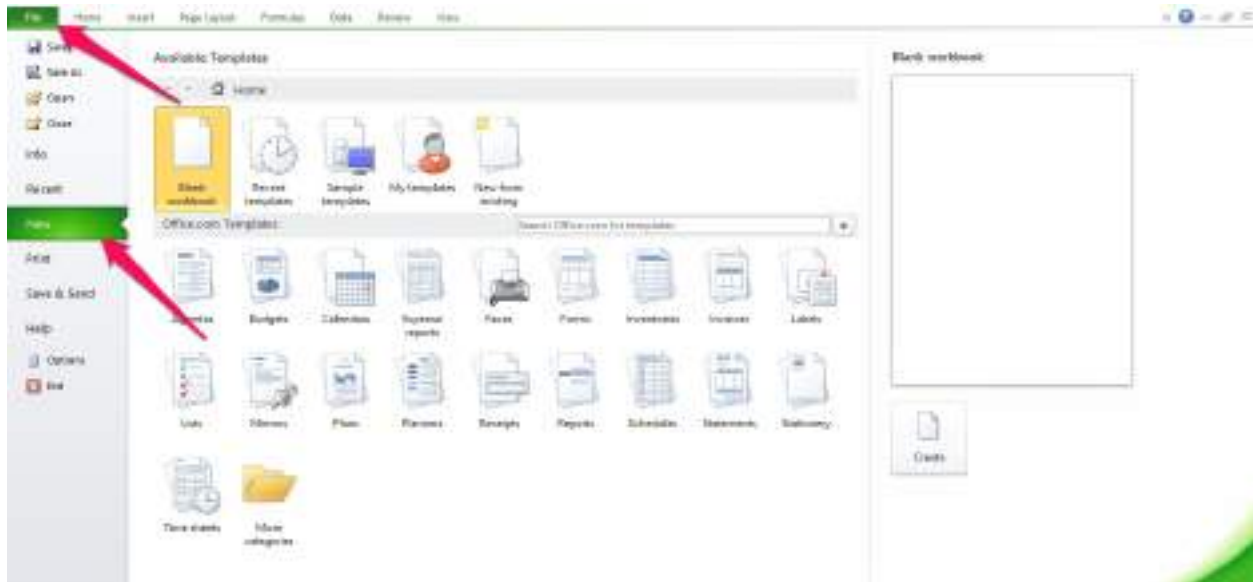
Before diving into Excel's functionalities, you need to know how to create and set up a new workbook.

Steps to Create a New Workbook:

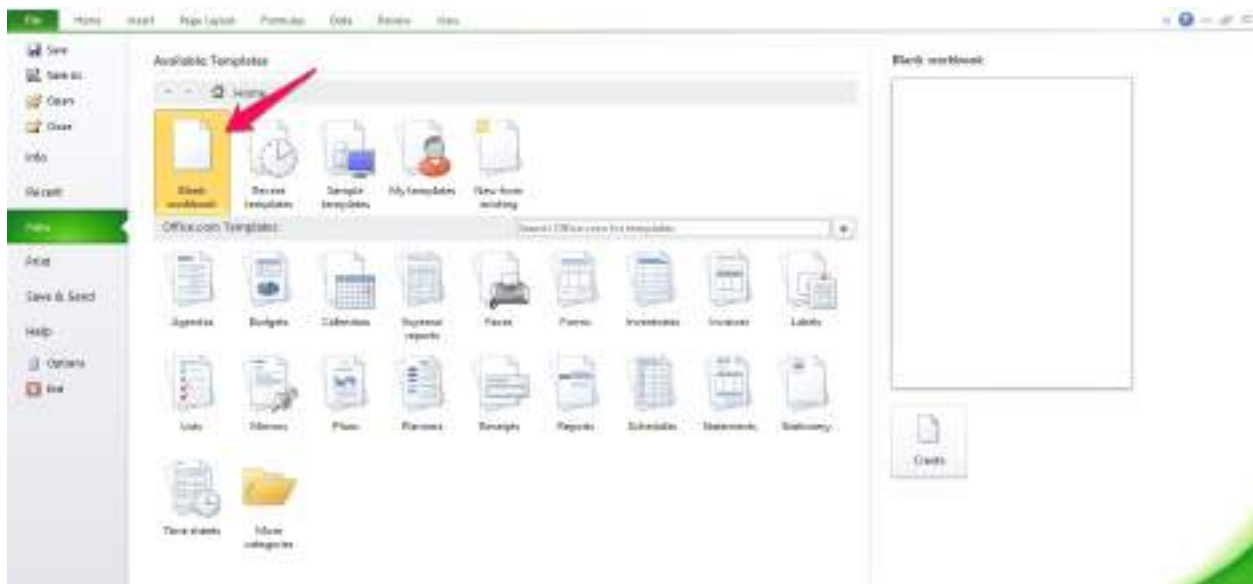
- **Open Excel:** Start by launching Microsoft Excel from your desktop or the start menu.



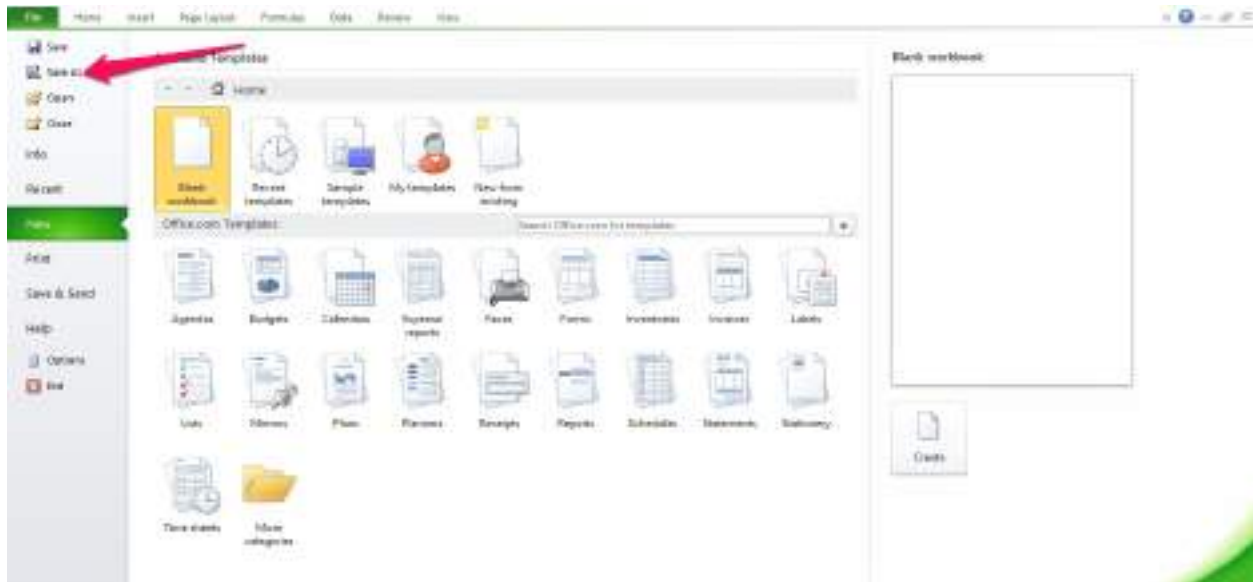
- **New Workbook:** Once Excel is open, click on "File" in the top-left corner, then select New.



- **Choose a Blank Workbook:** You will see various templates, but for now, select the Blank Workbook option.



- **Save Your Workbook:** To prevent losing your work, click on "File" and select Save As to name and save your new workbook.



Tip: Save your workbook frequently as you work to avoid losing any important data.

Getting Acquainted with Excel

Before you start entering data, it's important to get comfortable with Excel's interface and main features.

Key Components of the Excel Interface:

- **Ribbon:** The main toolbar at the top contains tabs (Home, Insert, Page Layout, etc.), each with groups of related commands.
- **Formula Bar:** Located above the worksheet area, the formula bar displays the content of the selected cell, whether it's a value, formula, or text.
- **Worksheet Area:** The grid of rows and columns where you will enter data. Each intersection is called a cell.
- **Status Bar:** Located at the bottom, it shows information about your current selection and can display additional information, such as the sum or average of selected cells.

Navigating the Excel Workbook:

Use the arrow keys or mouse to move between cells.

Ctrl + Arrow keys help navigate quickly across large datasets.

Entering Data in a Worksheet

Entering data is the core of Excel. Here's how to do it effectively:

Steps to Enter Data:

- **Select a Cell:** Click on a cell to select it. The cell will be outlined with a border.
- **Type Data:** Simply start typing to enter text, numbers, or formulas.
- **Press Enter:** After entering data in a cell, hit Enter to move to the next row, or Tab to move to the next column.

Tip: Press Esc if you want to cancel or clear the current input.

Quickly Entering Lists and Serial Data with the AutoFill Command

One of Excel's most powerful features is AutoFill, which saves you time when entering repetitive data, like lists or serial numbers.

Steps to Use AutoFill:

- **Enter Initial Data:** Start by typing the first item in a list or a serial number in a cell.
- **Select the Cell:** Click on the small square at the bottom-right corner of the cell (the Fill Handle).
- **Drag the Handle:** Drag the Fill Handle down or across the adjacent cells to autofill the data.

Examples:

To create a series like 1, 2, or 3, simply type "1" in a cell, then drag the Fill Handle.

For days of the week, type "Monday" and drag the Fill Handle to fill the rest of the days.

Tip: Excel can auto-fill dates, numbers, months, and even custom lists.

Formatting Numbers, Dates, and Time Values

Formatting ensures your data is displayed clearly and correctly. Whether you are working with numbers, dates, or time, proper formatting can help make the data more understandable.

Steps to Format Data:

- **Select the Data:** Highlight the cells you wish to format.
- **Go to the Home Tab:** In the Number group, you'll find various formatting options.

For Numbers: Choose between different number formats, such as currency, percentage, or general number formatting.

For Dates and Times: Excel has predefined date and time formats. Select a cell, click on the Number Format dropdown in the Home tab, and choose your preferred date or time format.

Tip: Use the Format Cells dialog box (right-click the cell and select Format Cells) for more options.

Establishing Data-Validation Rules

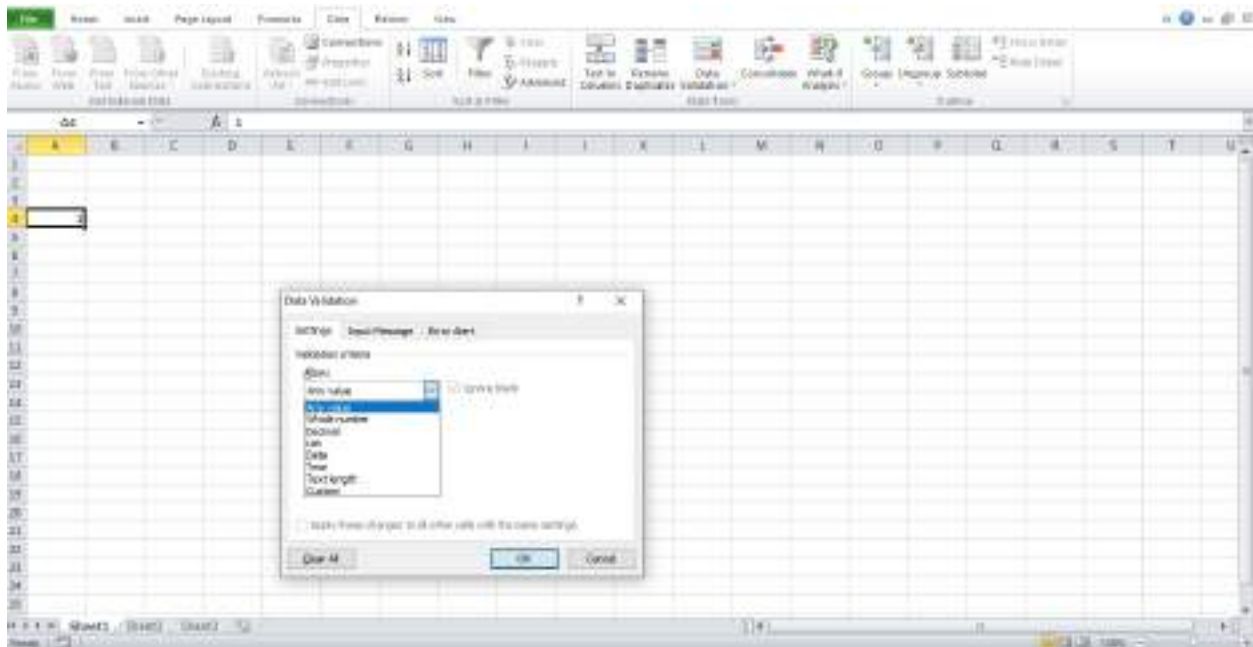
Data validation allows you to control what type of data can be entered into a cell, helping to avoid errors.

Steps to Set Up Data Validation:

- **Select the Cell:** Click on the cell where you want to apply validation.
- **Go to the Data Tab:** Click on Data in the ribbon and select Data Validation.



- **Choose Validation Criteria:** In the Data Validation window, you can define the type of data allowed, such as whole numbers, dates, or text.



- **Input Message and Error Alert:** You can also add a message to guide users and set up an error alert if the wrong type of data is entered.

Example: If you only want to allow numbers between 1 and 100 in a cell, you can set that as a validation rule.

Tip: Data validation can also be used to create dropdown lists to make data entry easier and more consistent.

CHAPTER 2

Refining Your Worksheet

After entering data into an Excel worksheet, the next step is refining it for better organization, readability, and collaboration. This chapter covers essential skills such as editing data, navigating efficiently, using comments, selecting and managing cells, and protecting worksheets from unwanted changes.

Editing Worksheet Data

Editing data in Excel is straightforward, allowing you to modify entries without retyping everything.

Ways to Edit Data in a Cell

1. Direct Editing:

- Double-click the cell and modify the content.
- Press Enter to save changes.

2. Using the Formula Bar:

- Select the cell.
- Edit the data in the Formula Bar above the worksheet.

3. Replacing Data:

- Click on the cell and start typing; the new data will replace the old one.

4. Undo and Redo Changes:

- Press Ctrl + Z to undo.
- Press Ctrl + Y to redo.

5. Find and Replace:

- Press Ctrl + H to open the Find & Replace dialog.
- Enter the data to be replaced and the new value, then click Replace All.

Moving Around in a Worksheet

Navigating efficiently in Excel saves time and enhances productivity.

Keyboard Shortcuts for Navigation

- **Arrow Keys:** Move one cell at a time.
- **Ctrl + Arrow Keys:** Jump to the last filled cell in a row or column.
- **Home:** Moves to the beginning of a row.
- **Ctrl + Home:** Moves to the first cell (A1).
- **Page Up/Page Down:** Moves one screen up or down.
- **Ctrl + Page Up/Page Down:** Switches between worksheet tabs.

Using the Name Box for Quick Navigation

Located next to the Formula Bar, the Name Box allows direct navigation. Enter a cell reference (e.g., B10) and press Enter to jump to that cell.

Getting a Better Look at the Worksheet

Viewing your worksheet comfortably helps in analyzing and editing data.

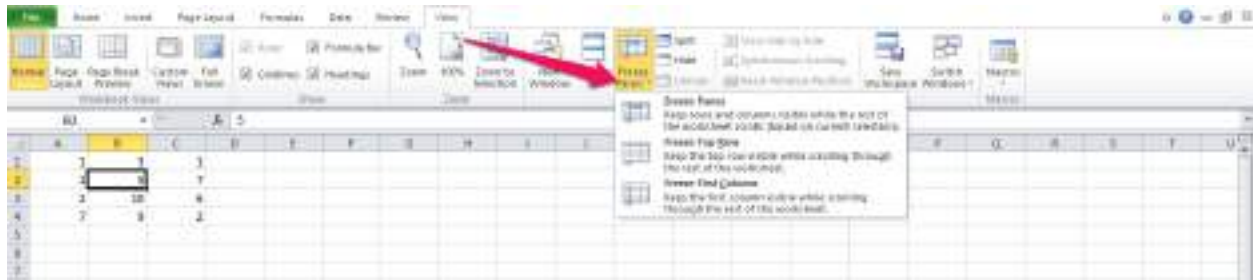
Zooming In and Out

Use the Zoom Slider in the bottom-right corner.
Press Ctrl + Scroll Wheel on your mouse to zoom in/out.
Go to View → Zoom and set a custom zoom percentage.

Freezing Panes for Better Visibility

Freezing panes keeps rows or columns visible while scrolling.

- Select the row below or column to the right of what you want to freeze.
- Click on View → Freeze Panes.



- Choose from:

Freeze Top Row: Keeps the first row visible.

Freeze First Column: Keeps the first column visible.

Freeze Panes: Freezes both rows and columns based on selection.

Splitting the Worksheet

Click on a cell where you want the split to occur.

Go to View → Split to divide the worksheet into scrollable sections.



Notes for Documenting Your Worksheet

Adding notes helps clarify data usage, making it easier to understand later.

Adding a Note

- Select a cell.
- Go to Review → Notes → New Note.
- Type your comment and press Enter.



Editing and Deleting Notes

- Click on the note and edit the text.
- Right-click the note and select Delete Note if no longer needed.

Comments for Collaborating with Others on a Workbook

Comments in Excel allow team members to discuss data directly within the workbook.

Adding a Comment

- Select a cell.
- Go to Review → New Comment.
- Type the comment and press Enter.

Replying to Comments

- Click on an existing comment.
- Select Reply to continue the discussion.

Editing and Deleting Comments

- Right-click on a comment and choose Edit Comment.
- To remove a comment, right-click and select Delete Comment.

Selecting Cells in a Worksheet

Selecting cells properly is crucial for formatting, moving data, or applying functions.

Methods to Select Cells

- **Single Cell:** Click on a cell.
- **Multiple Adjacent Cells:** Click and drag across a range.
- **Entire Row/Column:** Click on the row number or column letter.
- **Select All:** Press Ctrl + A or click the Select All button at the top-left.
- **Non-Adjacent Cells:** Hold Ctrl and click different cells.

Deleting, Copying, and Moving Data

Managing data efficiently is essential in Excel.

Deleting Data

- **Delete Content Only:** Select the cell and press Delete.
- **Delete Cell and Shift Data:** Right-click → Delete → Choose how to shift cells.
- **Delete Entire Row/Column:** Right-click the row or column header and choose Delete.

Copying and Moving Data

- Copy (Ctrl + C) and Paste (Ctrl + V).
- Cut (Ctrl + X) and Paste (Ctrl + V) to move data.
- Use Drag and Drop: Click and drag the selection to a new location.

Using Paste Special

After copying, right-click and choose Paste Special to paste values, formatting, or formulas only.

Handling the Worksheets in a Workbook

Excel workbooks can contain multiple worksheets, making it easier to manage

different sets of data.

Adding, Renaming, and Deleting Worksheets

- **Add a New Worksheet:** Click + next to sheet tabs or press Shift + F11.
- **Rename a Worksheet:** Double-click the sheet tab and enter a new name.
- **Delete a Worksheet:** Right-click the sheet tab and select Delete.

Rearranging Worksheets

- Click and drag a sheet tab to reorder it.
- Right-click the sheet tab → Move or Copy to transfer it within or to another workbook.

Keeping Others from Tampering with Worksheets

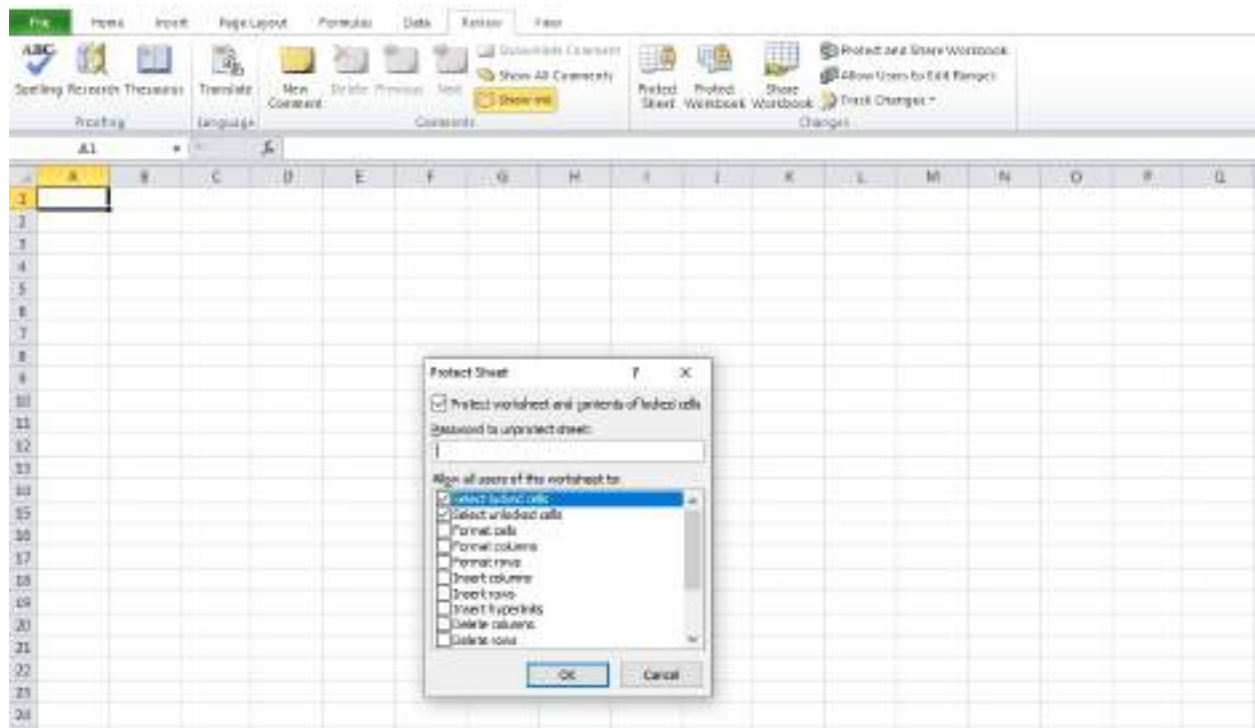
To prevent accidental changes, Excel provides worksheet protection options.

Protecting a Worksheet

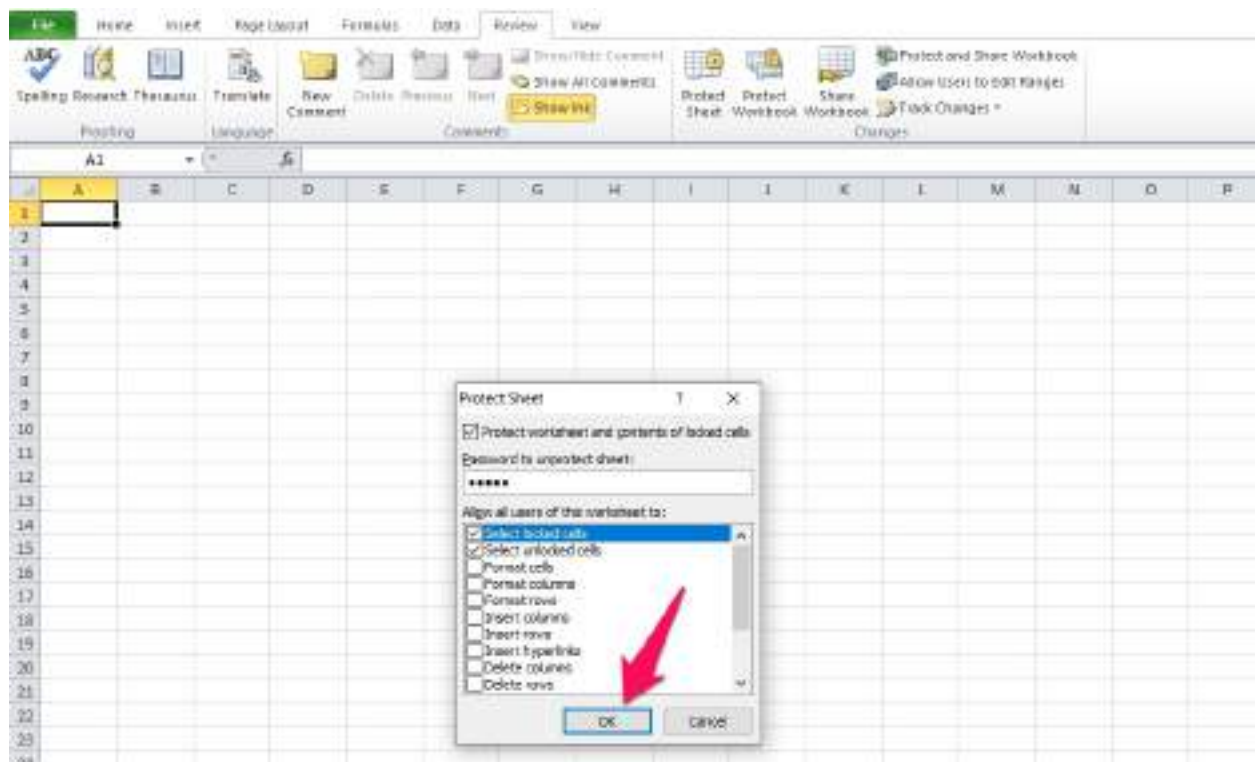
1. Click on Review → Protect Sheet.



2. Set a password (optional) and select allowed actions (e.g., allow formatting but not editing).



3. Click OK to apply protection.



Unprotecting a Worksheet